TECH DEBT

ELEVATED

TEST SUITE COLLAPSE

So many tests are marked skipped or permanently broken that the CI pipeline is effectively decorative. A defective change passed all checks and made it to production undetected. Your engineers found out about the bug via a customer support ticket.

Test coverage is one of the most reliable leading indicators of future defect rates and deployment confidence. The testing pyramid (unit tests at the base, integration tests in the middle, end-to-end tests at the top) provides a cost-effective coverage strategy. Critically, a test suite should have zero tolerance for skipped or broken tests — every skip is a decision to accept unknown risk. Test failure rates and coverage trends should be tracked as engineering metrics alongside deployment frequency and lead time. Continuous Testing in DevOps means tests run automatically on every commit, every pull request, and in pre-production environments that mirror production data volumes and configuration. Mutation testing goes further, verifying that your tests actually catch the bugs they claim to.

A green build that lies is worse than no tests at all. It creates false confidence and removes your only safety net.

TEAM DISCUSSION

What percentage of your test suite is actually running and meaningful? What is your coverage on critical user journeys?